Part V: Ages, Resurrection, and the Door into Revelation

Chapter 25: What age is ending?

Part IV ended by clearing the question I had been carrying since the beginning. What it also did was remove my last excuse for postponing this one.

The phrase *the end of the age* had been sitting in front of me since Part II. It is in the disciples' question on the Mount of Olives. It is in the last sentence of Matthew's Gospel. I had read past it for years, because I thought I already knew what it meant, and what I thought it meant was *the end of everything*.

That turns out not to be a translation. It is an assumption I was attaching to an English word.

THE WORD I HAD BEEN HEARING WRONG

> **WORD STUDY — αἰών (*AIŌN*) AND συντέλεια τοῦ αἰῶνος (*SYNTELEIA TOU AIŌNOS*)**
>
> αἰών (*aiōn*) — an age, an era, an epoch. A period or order of time.
>
> συντέλεια (*synteleia*) — consummation, completion, culmination. A bringing to an appointed conclusion.
>
> Together: **the consummation of the age.** Not, in the words themselves, the destruction of the earth.
>
> That is not a small clarification. It means the phrase does not answer the question people assume it answers. It raises one instead, and the question is unavoidable once the words are read as they stand: **which age?**

I want to be careful here, because this is the kind of observation that can be used dishonestly. Showing that a phrase *can* mean something narrower is not the same as showing that it *does*. A word study that ends by announcing the result its author wanted is not evidence, it is decoration.

So the question is whether Matthew himself makes the distinction, or whether I am making it for him.

YESHUA INTERPRETS HIS OWN PARABLE, SO I AM NOT GUESSING

Matthew 13 contains the one thing I want most in a disputed passage and almost never get: the speaker explaining His own symbolism, on the record, in the same chapter.

> The field is the world [*kosmos*], and the good seed is the sons of the kingdom. The weeds are the sons of the evil one, and the enemy who sowed them is the devil. The harvest is the end of the age [*synteleia tou aiōnos*], and the reapers are angels. (Matthew 13:38–39)

Read that twice, watching the nouns.

FINDING — THE TWO WORDS APPEAR IN ADJACENT CLAUSES, AND THEY ARE NOT THE SAME WORD

The field is the κόσμος (*kosmos*). The harvest is the συντέλεια τοῦ αἰῶνος.

The field is **not** the age. The harvest is **not** the destruction of the world. Matthew uses both words inside a single interpretation, a few syllables apart, and he uses them for different things.

Every argument this book has made about refusing to collapse *kosmos*, *oikoumenē*, *gē* and *aiōn* into one another now has a warrant from inside the text rather than from my own reasoning about it. And I did not arrive at it by argument. I arrived at it by reading a passage I had read many times, slowly enough to notice which nouns were in it.

The author who uses both words in one sentence is not treating them as interchangeable. Neither may I.

AND THE HARVEST HAS CONTENT I AM NOT ALLOWED TO SOFTEN

Here is where I have to be honest about which direction the evidence runs, because it does not all run my way.

> Just as the weeds are gathered and burned with fire, so will it be at the end of the age. The Son of Man will send his angels, and they will gather out of his kingdom all causes of sin and all law-breakers, and throw them into the fiery furnace… Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. (Matthew 13:40–43)

> **MATTHEW 13'S HARVEST — AGAINST THE READING I WAS MOVING TOWARD**
>
> This puts real pressure on any casual claim that *the end of the age* means simply *the Temple was destroyed, and nothing more.*
>
> There is harvest here. Angelic agency. Separation of the wicked from the righteous. Fiery judgment. The righteous shining.
>
> A first-century reading has to **account for** that material. Waving at it is not accounting for it.
>
> The harvest material CONTRADICTS the thin version of the hypothesis I was developing, the one where age-ending language reduces entirely to the fall of Jerusalem with no remainder.
>
> This is recorded at full strength, in the chapter that found it, because a model that only ever collects its own supporting evidence is not being tested.

I am not going to resolve that here. I am going to carry it.

THE DRAGNET SAYS IT A THIRD TIME

The pattern is not a single occurrence I might be over-reading. And I should be exact about the count, because I got it wrong on a first pass and the correction runs in my favour. The expression occurs **three times in Matthew 13 alone** — at 13:39 in the interpretation, again at 13:40 in the application of it, and a third time here in the dragnet.

> …a net "gathered fish of every kind… So it will be at the end of the age. The angels will come out and separate the evil from the righteous and throw them into the fiery furnace." (Matthew 13:47–50)

	WHEAT AND WEEDS (13:36–43)	DRAGNET (13:47–50)
agency	angels	angels
action	gathering	gathering
result	separation	separation
outcome	fiery judgment	fiery judgment

Matthew's consummation of the age is not merely a way of saying *later*. It carries judicial and separative content three times over, in a single chapter.

A VERSE I AM DELIBERATELY NOT GOING TO USE

Immediately after the dragnet, Matthew writes this:

> "Have you understood all these things?" They said to him, "Yes." And he said to them, "Therefore every scribe who has been trained for the kingdom of heaven is like a master

> of a house, who brings out of his treasure what is new and what is old." (Matthew 13:51–52)

Not *the old discarded and the new substituted*. A treasure containing both.

That is the most quotable verse in the chapter for the covenant argument I spent Part III building, and it is exactly the kind of verse that gets over-used because it is satisfying. So I am recording it as resonance with the continuity pattern this book has already found, and I am not making it carry anything. If the covenant argument needs this verse, the covenant argument was weaker than I thought.

THE FOURTH OCCURRENCE, AND WHERE MATTHEW HAS PLACED IT

Matthew 23 pronounces judgment on *this generation*. Then the Temple: not one stone left upon another. Then, privately, on the Mount of Olives:

> Tell us, when will these things be, and what will be the sign of your coming and of the consummation of the age? (Matthew 24:3)

The same phrase. And by the time Matthew's reader reaches it, chapter 13 has already loaded it with harvest, angels, gathering, separation and judgment.

THE CORRESPONDENCE, AND WHICH WAY THE BURDEN RUNS

MATTHEW 13	MATTHEW 24
Son of Man	Son of Man
συντέλεια τοῦ αἰῶνος	συντέλεια τοῦ αἰῶνος
angels	angels
gathering	gathering
separation and judgment	judgment
kingdom	kingdom proclamation

This does not prove every detail of the two passages refers to one event. What it does is shift the burden. Anyone proposing two completely unrelated ends of the age inside a single Gospel has to explain why Matthew keeps surrounding the phrase with the same imagery.

And I want to flag what just happened to my own rule, because it matters more than the result.

The Equivalent-Scope Burden is the principle I adopted earlier: do not treat two different scope words as equivalent without warrant. In Chapter 23 it **destroyed** a bridge I was using — Paul never chooses *oikoumenē*, so I could not build on it, and Chapter 21 records what that cost me. Here the same rule runs the other way and supports a connection I want.

A rule that only ever helped me would be a bias with a rule's name on it. The only reason this one is worth anything is that I have already watched it take something away.

THE CONSEQUENCE I DID NOT WANT

If Matthew 24 belongs substantially to the first-century judgment on Jerusalem, then a question follows that is considerably larger than *Jerusalem was destroyed*:

Does Matthew 13's harvest belong to that horizon too?

That asks whether the destruction of the Temple constitutes a covenantal harvest and judgment that Matthew is describing in final-sounding language. It is a legitimate hypothesis. It is not a demonstrated one, and the difference is the whole book.

> **A rule I am stating now, before I need it**
>
> If the model calls the fiery furnace symbolic, it does not get to call the angelic gathering literal merely because that reading is convenient.
>
> Whatever principle governs which elements are figurative has to be stated in advance and applied to the elements the model finds inconvenient as well as the ones it finds helpful. I am writing that down here, in the chapter where the temptation first appears, so that a later chapter cannot quietly help itself.

DANIEL 12 BECOMES UNAVOIDABLE

I had been hoping to reach Daniel on my own schedule. Matthew 13:43 removed that option.

> the righteous will **shine like the sun** (Matthew 13:43)
>
> those who are wise shall **shine like the brightness of the sky above**; and those who turn many to righteousness, like the stars forever and ever. (Daniel 12:3)

And the material around Daniel 12:3 is not quiet:

> At that time shall arise Michael… there shall be a time of trouble, such as never has been since there was a nation till that time… And many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt. (Daniel 12:1–2)
>
> shut up the words and seal the book, until the time of the end. (Daniel 12:4)
>
> you shall rest and shall stand in your allotted place at the end of the days. (Daniel 12:13)

WORD STUDY — וְרַבִּים (*RABBIM*) AT DANIEL 12:2, RECORDED AND SET DOWN

The Hebrew is וְרַבִּים (*rabbim*) — **many**. Not *all*.

I noted this and then deliberately stopped. It is going to matter for how resurrection is counted, and I can already see that it will bear on a line in Revelation 20 about the rest of the dead.

Which is exactly why I am not building on it now. Reaching forward to a passage I have not yet earned the right to read, in order to strengthen a model I am still assembling, is the precise failure this method exists to prevent.

Recorded. Not used.

If Matthew's age-ending harvest echoes Daniel 12, then Daniel's resurrection language becomes a question I cannot dodge — and where Daniel locates that resurrection becomes a test this model has to pass rather than a detail it can route around. That may turn out to be the hardest test in the whole investigation.

THE FIFTH OCCURRENCE

> I am with you all the days, until the consummation of the age. (Matthew 28:20)

That is the fifth and last. Matthew has now attached this phrase to harvest, judgment, angels and separation three separate times in chapter 13; to the Temple judgment, the coming, the gathering and *this generation* in chapter 24; and

now to the **duration of the commission given to the eleven.**

WHAT I ACTUALLY HAVE, STATED AS A MODEL AND NOT AS A CONCLUSION

STAGE IN MATTHEW	CONTENT
Matthew 10	mission restricted primarily to Israel
Matthew 13	harvest at the consummation of the age
Matthew 23	judgment pronounced on *this generation*
Matthew 24	Temple destruction, proclamation through the *oikoumenē*, coming and gathering, *this generation*
Matthew 28	the risen Messiah commissions the eleven to the nations, present until the consummation of the age

Israel-centred mission, then Messiah rejected, crucified and raised, then a mission to the nations, then proclamation through the inhabited world, then a covenantal harvest and judgment, then the consummation of the age.

That is a genuine textual model, and I want to be exact about what makes it one. It is not *preterism says so*. Matthew supplied the pieces and Matthew supplied them in that order. But assembled is not proven, and the next section is why.

AND HERE IS WHAT IT HAS TO SURVIVE

OPEN QUESTION — THE OBJECTIONS, NAMED HERE SO THEY CANNOT BE DROPPED LATER

1. Matthew 13 sounds like ultimate judgment rather than covenantal transition.
2. Daniel 12 sounds like resurrection of the dead.
3. Matthew 24 contains cosmic imagery and a gathering.
4. Matthew speaks elsewhere of judgment in ways that may reach past AD 70.
5. Believers have understood Matthew 28's disciple-making as ongoing for the entire period since. That is a fact about reception rather than about the text, but it is a real fact and it deserves better than dismissal.

A serious first-century reading has to explain these **better** than the alternatives do. If it cannot, the model gets revised rather than defended.

I am stating them in the chapter that built the model, for the same reason I stated the symbolism rule above.

WHERE THIS LEAVES US. *The consummation of the age* is not, in its own words, the destruction of the earth, and Matthew proves the distinction himself by using *kosmos* for the field and *aiōn* for the harvest in adjacent clauses. The expression occurs five times in Matthew — three of them inside chapter 13 — surrounded each time by related imagery, which shifts the burden onto anyone claiming the occurrences are unrelated. A coherent first-century sequence is now visible in Matthew's own ordering. What is not established is that the sequence is the right reading: chapter 13's judgment content, Daniel 12's resurrection language, and the long reception of Matthew 28 all stand against it and are kept at full strength. Daniel 12:2 says *many*, not *all* — recorded, and not yet used.

> **THE QUESTION THIS LEAVES.** The question stopped being whether everything ends and became which age reaches its appointed completion. Matthew also named two ages in passing, which is the cleaner question and the one I should have asked first.

Chapter 26: “this age” and “the age to come”

The last chapter ended on a verse I had walked past while looking at something else. Before Matthew ever writes *the consummation of the age*, Matthew has already said there are two ages.

That is the cleaner question, and I should have asked it first. If *this age* simply means all of ordinary human history up to a final judgment, then the transition I was starting to see in Matthew has a serious problem. If the apostolic writers instead understood themselves to be standing at an overlap between two ages, then *the consummation of the age* may mean something a good deal more specific.

I did not want to decide that in advance. I wanted to follow the language.

TWO AGES, AND YESHUA IS THE ONE COUNTING

> whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven, either in this age [ἐν τούτῳ τῷ αἰῶνι] or in the age to come [ἐν τῷ μέλλοντι]. (Matthew 12:32)

The second is not merely *the future*. It is *the coming age* — a named thing, set against a present one.

So Matthew possesses an age-to-age framework before he ever uses the phrase I spent the last chapter on. That is on the surface of the text.

AND THE FRAMEWORK IS NOT PECULIAR TO MATTHEW

> …will not fail to receive a hundredfold now in this time… and in the age to come eternal life. (Mark 10:29–30)

Luke has the same contrast. And then Luke gives the one that presses hardest against where I was heading.

> The sons of this age marry and are given in marriage, but those who are considered worthy to attain to that age and to the resurrection from the dead neither marry nor are given in marriage, for they cannot die anymore, because they are equal to angels and are sons of God, being sons of the resurrection. (Luke 20:34–36)

> **LUKE 20 — AGAINST A PURELY ADMINISTRATIVE READING OF THE TRANSITION**
>
> The coming age is here associated with **resurrection from the dead**, and with a condition in which those who attain it **cannot die anymore**.
>
> That prevents reducing the age transition to *the Temple administration changed*. There is an eschatological dimension in the coming age, and Yeshua states it. It is not something a system inferred and then read back in.
>
> Luke 20 CONTRADICTS any version of my developing model that would let the age change be a covenantal-administrative event with no resurrection attached.
>
> Kept at full strength. It becomes this chapter's major unresolved problem, and I would rather end with it unresolved than end with it managed.

THE CONTRAST IS TEMPORAL, NOT COSMOLOGICAL

Worth saying plainly, because it is easy to slide past: Yeshua does not say *this earth* against *another earth*. He says *this age* against *that age*. Age to age.

Whatever consequences accompany such a transition are separate questions that have to be established separately. The text gives ages. That is the same discipline Matthew forced on me in the last chapter, when he used one word for the field and another for the harvest — now holding across different authors.

A detour I took between these two chapters, and what it cost me to learn

Somewhere around here I got ahead of myself. I had a question — *who is actually alive during the thousand years?* — and it felt like a real problem. If the thousand years began with a resurrection, where do the nations at the end of it come from? Something would have to repopulate the earth.

And I noticed what I had started doing to answer it. I was reaching outward, toward historical anomalies and proposed explanations of the recent past, looking for a mechanism that would solve the difficulty.

Then I went back and read the passage.

Satan is bound *so that he might not deceive the nations any longer, until the thousand years were ended.* Binding him so that he cannot deceive the nations until then rather plainly implies that the nations are there the whole time. The text never says they were resurrected at that point, never says they were created at that point, and never says the earth had been emptied and needed refilling.

The problem dissolved once I read the passage. It had never existed. And I had been reaching for external explanations to solve a biblical difficulty before anyone had verified that the difficulty was real.

I am keeping this in the book because it is the most instructive mistake I made in this stretch, and because it establishes a firewall I am going to need later: claims about recent history and claims about what a text says are two different classes of evidence, and the first may not be used to settle the second. None of this decides anything about Revelation, which I have not opened and am not going to open early.

PAUL: ALREADY ENTHRONED, AND STILL "THIS AGE"

> God raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly places, far above all rule and authority and power and dominion, and above every name that is

> named, not only in this age but also in the one to come. (Ephesians 1:20–21)

Messiah is already enthroned, and Paul is still calling his own period *this age*.

That complicates tidy timelines in both directions, and I want both columns on the page:

CANNOT BE SAID	BECAUSE
Messiah becomes King only when the coming age begins	Paul already portrays Him as enthroned
Messiah's resurrection instantly ended the previous age	Paul still distinguishes this age from the one to come, after the resurrection

Something has genuinely begun without everything belonging to the previous order having reached its conclusion. By now that pattern is not a surprise: it is what Part III found about fulfilment and abolition, and what Part IV found about mission and completion. It keeps being transition rather than instant replacement.

PAUL LOCATES HIS OWN GENERATION, AND THE VERB DECIDES IT

> …written down for our instruction, on whom the ends of the ages have come. (1 Corinthians 10:11)

In English that reads like a flourish. The Greek is harder to soften.

TEXTUAL NOTE — τὰ τέλη τῶν αἰώνων AND THE TENSE OF κατήντηκεν (*KATĒNTĒKEN*)

ELEMENT	FORM	FORCE
τέλη *(telē)*	plural of *telos*	ends, culminations
αἰώνων *(aiōnōn)*	plural of *aiōn*	of the ages
κατήντηκεν *(katēntēken)*	**PERFECT INDICATIVE ACTIVE**	have arrived, and the arrival stands

The perfect presents the arrival as a completed development whose resulting state is in view. And the pronoun is *us*.

Paul does not write that the ends of the ages will eventually come upon people many centuries later. He places his own community at the arrival point.

What this establishes, stated exactly: apostolic self-location. Paul considered his own generation eschatologically transitional. That is a textual observation before it is anyone's interpretation, and it is **not** proof of any particular date.

One more thing about that verse, recorded rather than used. *Telē* is the plural of τέλος (*telos*) — the same lexeme as Matthew 24:14's *the end* and Romans 10:4's *end of the law*. This is its third load-bearing appearance in my investigation. Chapter 21 is where I learned what happens when a shared lemma gets quietly counted as corroboration, and I am not doing that again. Same word, three contexts, three meanings to be established separately.

HEBREWS ARRIVES AT THE SAME PLACE FROM A DIFFERENT DIRECTION

> he has appeared once for all at the end of the ages to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself. (Hebrews 9:26)

Paul says the ends of the ages have come upon *us*. Hebrews places Messiah's appearance *at the end of the ages*. Two authors, independently, putting the decisive events at a culmination rather than at the opening of a long ordinary stretch.

AND HEBREWS 6 PRODUCES THE OVERLAP OUT OF THE TEXT ITSELF

> those who have once been enlightened, who have tasted the heavenly gift, and have shared in the Holy Spirit, and have tasted the goodness of the word of God and the powers of the age to come. (Hebrews 6:4–5)

The coming age has not fully arrived. First-century believers have already tasted its powers.

That is an overlap emerging from a sentence rather than an overlap invented to reconcile passages that would not otherwise fit. The difference between those two things is the difference between reading a text and managing one.

A DISTINCTION I AM ADOPTING, AND A SYSTEM I AM NOT

The standard term for this is *inaugurated eschatology*: a promised reality has genuinely begun while aspects of its consummation remain outstanding. Often shortened to *already, but not yet*.

I am adopting the distinction and attaching no system to it, because the concept is not the property of either side of this argument. A futurist and a preterist can both agree that Messiah inaugurated realities before their consummation, and then disagree entirely about when the consummation occurred or will occur. Which is precisely the question I am still inside.

THE FINDING THIS CHAPTER DID NOT WANT

> For it was not to angels that God subjected the world to come, of which we are speaking. (Hebrews 2:5)

I checked the Greek because the phrase looked ordinary. It is not ordinary.

HEBREWS 2:5 — A CORRECTION TO MY OWN EARLIER SCOPE WORK

The word is οἰκουμένην τὴν μέλλουσαν (*oikoumenēn tēn mellousan*) — **the inhabited world to come.**

οἰκουμένη (*oikoumenē*) is Matthew 24:14's word. The word I spent Part II and Part IV establishing need not mean every location on the earth. And Hebrews attaches it to a **coming** order.

Hebrews 2:5 **CONTRADICTS** any use of my scope work that would let *oikoumenē* simply mean *the first-century Roman inhabited world* wherever it appears.

Neither observation cancels the other. Luke's census and famine still show the word can carry a limited referent; Hebrews shows the same word can denote a future order. Together they mean the referent has to be determined at each occurrence rather than fixed once and reused.

That is the scope test doing exactly what I built it to do, and this time it is doing it to me.

HEBREWS 8:13, AND THE BRAKE I AM PUTTING ON IT

> what is becoming obsolete and growing old is ready to vanish away. (Hebrews 8:13)

Becoming obsolete. *Growing* old. *Ready* to vanish. Something new already exists while something old has not finished disappearing — which fits the age-overlap structure so well that I want to use it.

I am not going to. Hebrews 8 is explicitly discussing **covenant**. Treating covenant and age as the same structure would

be the cleanest move available to me here, and I have not proved they are the same structure. Two things with the same shape are not thereby the same thing. The correspondence is suggestive and it stays suggestive.

WHAT IS CONVERGING, LAID OUT RATHER THAN RESOLVED

TEXT	WHAT IT CONNECTS
Matthew 13	consummation, harvest, Daniel-like shining
Luke 20	the coming age, resurrection from the dead
Daniel 12	the time of the end, awakening from the dust, the righteous shining

These are converging on the same place, and it is not a place I chose. It is resurrection.

And there may be a harder test than Daniel waiting:

> Christ has been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep… But each in his own order: Christ the firstfruits, then at his coming those who belong to Christ. Then comes the end, when he delivers the kingdom to God the Father after destroying every rule and every authority and power. For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. The last enemy to be destroyed is death. (1 Corinthians 15:20–26)

Resurrection, coming, kingdom and *the end*, in a stated order, with a stated final item. Whatever chronology I eventually build has to survive that paragraph. It may be a harder

test than Daniel 12, and the hardest texts are the ones worth having.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER DOES AND DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Established. The New Testament explicitly distinguishes this age from the coming age, across Matthew, Mark, Luke, Paul and Hebrews. Apostolic writers locate themselves at the ends of the ages, with 1 Corinthians 10:11 in the perfect tense. Messiah is already raised and enthroned during that period. First-century believers already experience powers belonging to the coming age.

Strongly suggested. The New Testament contains an overlapping, inaugurated age structure.

Plausible and not established. That the destruction of Jerusalem and the Temple marks the decisive consummation of *this age*. I have a model and I do not have a demonstration.

Unresolved and pressing. The coming age is associated with resurrection, and I have reconciled that with nothing. Hebrews 2:5 has corrected how I may use my own scope work.

THE CHAIN THAT GOT ME HERE

I started by asking whether I was personally commanded to proclaim the good news everywhere because Matthew 24:14 had not happened yet.

To answer it I had to ask what *world* meant. That forced audience and geography. Those forced Israel and the nations. That forced covenant. Covenant forced Torah and the new covenant. That forced Matthew 24. Matthew 24 forced the Danielic judgment language. That forced *the end of the age*.

And *the end of the age* has now forced resurrection.

That is not wandering. Each question earned the next one, and none of them was chosen because it looked helpful.

WHERE THIS LEAVES US. The two-age framework is explicit across five New Testament witnesses, and the apostolic writers place themselves at the culmination of the ages rather than at the start of a long ordinary stretch — 1 Corinthians 10:11's perfect tense makes that hard to soften. The overlap is not imported: Hebrews 6 states that believers have already tasted the powers of the coming age while it remains coming. What is not established is when the present age reaches its consummation. Against a first-century answer stand Luke 20's association of the coming age with resurrection, 1 Corinthians 15's stated order ending with death itself, and Hebrews 2:5, which uses Matthew 24:14's own word for a world still to come and corrects my earlier scope work in the process.

THE QUESTION THIS LEAVES. Resurrection stopped being a topic I would reach eventually and became the next thing I am required to take. And the order matters: if I settle the age question first and then interpret resurrection to fit, I will have done the one thing this whole method exists to prevent.

Chapter 27: resurrection before Revelation

I want to be explicit about why this chapter comes where it does, because the placement is the argument.

By the end of the last chapter I had a first-century age-transition model with enough coherence to be dangerous. Coherent models attract evidence. If I had gone on to build the chronology, settled it, and only then opened the resurrection texts, I know exactly what would have happened: I would have arrived at those texts already needing them to mean something, and I would have found a way for them to mean it.

So the resurrection texts go on the table now, before Revelation, before any chronology depends on them. The question is simple and unfriendly:

What does the New Testament mean by resurrection — and does the evidence permit a first-century consummation without redefining resurrection in order to protect that chronology?

DANIEL'S LANGUAGE IS NOT VAGUE

> …a time of trouble, such as never has been… But at that time your people shall be delivered, everyone whose name

> shall be found written in the book. And many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt. And those who are wise shall shine like the brightness of the sky above. (Daniel 12:1–3)

Sleep in the dust sounds like death. Not like a metaphor for death.

There is a move available to me here, and I can feel its pull: *Israel metaphorically woke up*. And I have to concede immediately that Scripture genuinely does use resurrection imagery for a people — Ezekiel 37 and its valley of dry bones is the standard case, and it is a real case, not a concession I am making for form's sake.

But Daniel's own markers are sleeping in dust, then awakening, then two divergent destinies. Those markers deserve prima facie weight as bodily resurrection, and any chronology that places Daniel 12 entirely in the first century inherits that burden rather than escaping it.

And the word I set down two chapters ago is still sitting there. Daniel says רַבִּים (*rabbim*) — *many* — not *all*. Still recorded. Still not argued from.

MATTHEW IS DRAWING ON THIS

> the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. (Matthew 13:43)

Against Daniel 12:3's *shine like the brightness of the sky above*.

Which means Matthew's harvest at the consummation of the age may be deliberately reaching for Danielic resurrection and judgment language. And that in turn means Matthew 13 cannot be read casually as a transfer of covenantal institutions. There is more weight behind it than my model was carrying.

"CANNOT DIE ANYMORE"

> …those who are considered worthy to attain to that age and to the resurrection from the dead… cannot die anymore… being sons of the resurrection. (Luke 20:34–36)

That sounds like transformed immortality. It does not sound like metaphorical national restoration.

If the age to come fully arrived in the first century, Luke 20 requires an answer to a plain question: where is the state in which those raised cannot die anymore? I do not have one. That is not a minor objection, and I am preserving it rather than managing it.

THE RESURRECTION QUESTION WAS CONTESTED, AND THE TEXTS SHOW IT

Two of the passages in this chapter carry their own evidence that resurrection was disputed in the first century rather than assumed.

Luke 20's discussion happens because the Sadducees, who deny that there is a resurrection, come to Yeshua with a test case designed to make the doctrine look absurd. The teaching about *that age* is His answer to people who rejected the category outright.

And Paul writes, to a congregation of believers, *how can some of you say that there is no resurrection of the dead?* (1 Corinthians 15:12). The denial he is arguing against is inside the assembly.

So resurrection is not background furniture in these texts. It is a live dispute, which is part of why the language is so explicit: both writers are arguing with people who deny the thing.

What this box does not cover: the broader Jewish evidence on resurrection expectation — Second Temple literature, Josephus on the parties, and later rabbinic discussion. I have not worked through it here, and I am not going to characterize a body of literature I have not read. What is above comes from the passages themselves.

JOHN MARKS THE DISTINCTION HIMSELF, AND THIS IS THE FIND

This is the most important control in the chapter, and I did not bring it from outside. It is inside one discourse, by one author.

I had seen John 5:28–29 quoted. I read the surrounding verses as a block, which is the only reason I noticed anything.

> whoever hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life. He does not come into judgment, but has passed from death to life. (John 5:24)
>
> an hour is coming, **and is now here**, when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who hear will live. (John 5:25)
>
> an hour is coming when all who are in the tombs will hear his voice and come out, those who have done good to the resurrection of life, and those who have done evil to the resurrection of judgment. (John 5:28–29)

Read verse 25 and verse 28 next to each other. At verse 25 John writes *and is now here*. At verse 28 that clause is absent.

FINDING — ONE AUTHOR, ONE DISCOURSE, TWO CATEGORIES, AND HE SEPARATES THEM

	JOHN 5:24–25	JOHN 5:28–29
timing marker	**"AND IS NOW HERE"**	**ABSENT**
who	the dead	**ALL WHO ARE IN THE TOMBS**
Greek	—	μνημείοις *(mnēmeiois)* — tombs, memorial monuments
action	hear, and live	hear, and **COME OUT**
category	already — passing from death to life	still coming — resurrection of life or of judgment

John juxtaposes present death-to-life language with future tomb-resurrection language in the same discourse and marks them differently. Verse 24 strongly supports a spiritual, death-to-life reading of the first; verses 28–29 explicitly describe tombs, coming out, and two destinies.

So spiritual-resurrection language may not be used to erase bodily-resurrection language. I do not need an external framework to separate the two in John, because John marks them differently himself. And *all who are in the tombs* is difficult to reduce to covenantal metaphor.

The structure is also close to Daniel 12: dead, then raised, then two destinies.

That gives me a rule, and I am writing it down where I found it.

Rule — metaphorical does not override bodily

Because Scripture *can* use death and resurrection imagery metaphorically, the existence of metaphorical resurrection language does not automatically redefine passages that explicitly describe tombs, dust, bodies, mortality, or coming forth from the dead.

Classify each passage by its own markers before harmonizing anything.

John 5 is the warrant, because the same author uses both in the same breath and marks them differently.

PAUL GROUNDS THE CATEGORY IN AN EVENT

Paul does not argue resurrection as a concept. He argues it from something he says happened, and then reasons from it.

> If Christ is proclaimed as raised from the dead, how can some of you say there is no resurrection of the dead? (1 Corinthians 15:12)

His logic runs from Messiah's resurrection to the category of resurrection for those who belong to Him. Which means whatever believers receive has to have meaningful continuity with what Messiah received. That weighs heavily against a purely metaphorical reading, and the governing image makes it heavier:

> Christ has been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep. (1 Corinthians 15:20)

Firstfruits implies same harvest, later sequence. If Messiah rose bodily and believers are the later portion of that same harvest, Paul is pointing at bodily resurrection.

THE STATED ORDER, AND THE LAST ENEMY

> each in his own order: Christ the firstfruits, then at his coming those who belong to Christ. Then comes the end… For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. The last enemy to be destroyed is death. (1 Corinthians 15:23–26)

Anyone placing Messiah's coming entirely in the first century has to explain how the resurrection of those who belong to Him, and the destruction of death, fit that chronology. It is not impossible by assertion. It is a heavy burden, and I am the one who would have to carry it.

The last enemy to be destroyed is death is a striking sentence precisely because ordinary human death visibly continues.

There are several available readings — death's legal or spiritual dominion, the second death, bodily mortality itself, or a staged fulfilment. I am not permitted to choose whichever one rescues my model. And the immediate context is about mortality putting on immortality, which points toward bodily death being in view.

TRANSFORMATION, NOT ABANDONMENT

> What is sown is perishable; what is raised is imperishable. It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. (1 Corinthians 15:42–44)

The phrase is σῶμα πνευματικόν (*sōma pneumatikon*) — *spiritual body*. Paul still says *sōma*. *Spiritual* is describing the body's mode or source or order. It does not mean *non-body*, and the phrase cannot be made to mean *not a body* without contradicting the noun it modifies.

Which brings up the verse most often used against all of this:

> flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, nor does the perishable inherit the imperishable. (1 Corinthians 15:50)

Read alone, that looks decisive. Paul's own next sentences are what happened to it:

> We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet… the dead will be raised imperishable, and we shall be changed. For this perishable body must put on the imperishable, and this mortal body must put on immortality. (1 Corinthians 15:51–53)

Paul does not say bodies are discarded. He says the perishable **puts on** imperishable and the mortal **puts on** immor-

tality. That is transformation, not abandonment — and it resists *resurrection means a changed covenant status* about as firmly as a text can.

This is the third time in this investigation that an objection has dissolved simply because I read the verses on either side of the one being quoted.

TWO SIMILARITIES I AM DECLINING TO CLOSE

Paul's *last trumpet* immediately suggests Matthew 24's trumpet and gathering, and 1 Thessalonians 4's trumpet. They may be the same event. The same symbol may also be used of different events, and I have already been burned once by treating a shared word as a shared referent. Similarity raises a question. It does not establish an identity.

And 1 Thessalonians 4 brings its own:

> the dead in Christ will rise first. (1 Thessalonians 4:16)

The text distinguishes dead believers from living ones and speaks of the dead rising — again pointing past metaphor. The Greek for the meeting that follows is ἀπάντησιν (*apantēsin*), a meeting or encounter. Some argue the term evokes citizens going out to meet an arriving dignitary and escorting him back in; others warn against building a technical rule from a handful of usages. I am bookmarking it rather than settling it, because it may matter later for

whether believers are taken away or go out to meet a coming king. The resurrection in the verse is explicit either way.

THE TAXONOMY, SO THAT DRIFT BECOMES VISIBLE

If I am going to be honest about resurrection language, I need to classify passages before I synthesize them, not after.

	CATEGORY	MARKERS
A	literal bodily resurrection	tombs, dust, bodies, mortality and immortality, *come out*
B	spiritual resurrection	passing from death to life while physically alive
C	corporate or national imagery	Ezekiel 37-type restoration of a people
D	martyr vindication or enthronement	not yet established as carrying resurrection meaning
E	final judgment resurrection	life against condemnation, both destinies present

And the passages, classified:

TEXT	CATEGORY	BASIS
Daniel 12:2	A / E	sleep in dust, awake, two destinies
John 5:24–25	B	passed from death to life, *and is now here*
John 5:28–29	A / E	*mnēmeiois*, come out, two destinies
Luke 20:34–36	A	cannot die anymore
1 Corinthians 15:42–54	A	*sōma* retained, mortal puts on immortality

TEXT	CATEGORY	BASIS
1 Thessalonians 4:16	A	the dead in Christ rise
Revelation 20:4–6	**unclassified**	**deliberately — that is what reading Revelation in sequence is for**

That last row is the whole discipline in one line. I know the passage exists. I know what my model would like it to say. It stays unclassified until I reach it honestly.

WHAT THIS DOES TO MY HYPOTHESIS, STATED BEFORE I CAN BE TEMPTED

A hypothesis that the thousand years already occurred survives only if the resurrection preceding it can be accounted for. There are four possibilities and all four are live:

1. A bodily resurrection of the martyrs already occurred.
2. *First resurrection* means something other than bodily resurrection — **and Revelation itself supplies sufficient evidence for that**, rather than my needing it to.
3. The chronology is not where I currently assume it is.
4. **The broader hypothesis is wrong.**

I have to be willing to land on the fourth. I am writing that down here, before Revelation is opened, because a falsification condition stated afterward is not a falsification condition. It is a retreat with better manners.

And because bodily resurrection is strongly established elsewhere, a symbolic reading of Revelation's first resurrection would carry a burden of proof. That rule applies to my own preferred reading first, which is the only thing that makes it a rule.

TWO RESONANCES KEPT APART, AND A PUZZLE LEFT STANDING

Luke says those who attain the resurrection *cannot die anymore*. Revelation says that over those who share in the first resurrection *the second death has no power*. Those resonate. They are not identical — one speaks of inability to die, the other specifically of the second death — and I am leaving the distinction open rather than quietly closing it.

The staging puzzle is worse, and I am stating it rather than solving it. Daniel says **many** awake. John says **all who are in the tombs** come out. Do Daniel and John compress several moments into one prophetic scene? Does Revelation's first resurrection mean something qualitatively different? Or am I misreading the sequence entirely? I do not know, and the not-knowing is load-bearing.

One thing is closed. The population question from my earlier detour — who is alive during the thousand years — is answered, and it is answered without touching resurrection timing. Saints reigning does not require everyone alive to be

raised. That solves one problem and leaves the other exactly as hard as it was.

WHERE THIS LEAVES US. Resurrection cannot be dissolved into covenantal metaphor. Daniel's dust, John's tombs, Luke's *cannot die anymore*, Paul's mortal putting on immortality, and the dead in Messiah rising all describe something bodily, and John shows the two can be told apart by marking them differently himself. That puts my first-century age-transition model under real pressure without destroying it: the model must now either distinguish inauguration from a later bodily consummation, demonstrate multiple stages from Scripture, or be revised. Revelation 20 remains unclassified on purpose, and possibility four — that the whole hypothesis is wrong — is on the record before I open it.

> **THE QUESTION THIS LEAVES.** A taxonomy that makes category drift visible, a rule that metaphor may not overwrite tombs, and a falsification condition written down before the passage that would tempt me to soften it. What it did not earn is permission to proceed. The next question is whether Scripture itself allows one age to reach its consummation while resurrection remains ahead — and if the answer is no, the model I have been building takes a serious hit.

Chapter 28: can an age end while resurrection remains ahead?

The last chapter left me with a narrow question, and everything now depends on it.

Does Scripture **require** every event associated with the consummation of the age to happen at once? Or can a covenantal and historical age reach its appointed end while bodily resurrection and the final defeat of death remain ahead of it?

If Scripture does not allow that distinction, my first-century model is in serious trouble. If it does, then AD 70 could be a genuine consummation without my having to claim that final resurrection occurred then.

And I have to be honest about the shape of that question, because it is exactly the kind of distinction a person invents when he needs one. It has to be earned from the text.

FIRST, A BRAKE ON MY OWN VOCABULARY

Paul's order ends with *then comes the end* — τὸ τέλος (*to telos*) — and includes the destruction of death. Matthew's phrase is συντέλεια τοῦ αἰῶνος.

Those are different expressions. They may point at the same ultimate horizon. But if I assume Matthew's consummation

is simply identical to Paul's final *telos*, then a first-century consummation becomes almost impossible unless bodily death was already defeated in Paul's sense, which it plainly was not.

I am not permitted to merge them because English translates both with the word *end*. That is the rule I adopted after Chapter 21, and it applies here whether or not I like the result.

AND THEN HEBREWS GIVES ME PART OF WHAT I WANTED, TWO VERSES APART

This is the finding of the chapter, and what makes it strong is that it is not a synthesis I assembled across authors. It is one writer, in one paragraph. What makes it *less* than I first claimed is something I only saw on a second pass, and it is in the preposition.

> But as it is, he has appeared once for all at the end of the ages to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself. (Hebrews 9:26)
>
> so Christ, having been offered once to bear the sins of many, will appear a second time, not to deal with sin but to save those who are eagerly waiting for him. (Hebrews 9:28)

FINDING — CONSUMMATION LANGUAGE DOES NOT ENTAIL ESCHATOLOGICAL EXHAUSTION

	HEBREWS 9
already	Messiah appeared **AT THE END OF THE AGES** (9:26)
still expected	Messiah **WILL APPEAR A SECOND TIME** to save those waiting (9:28)

The same author, in the same paragraph, places Messiah's appearance at the consummation of the ages **and** speaks of a second appearing still awaited.

What that establishes: consummation language need not mean that every eschatological reality has already arrived. The category is real and I did not have to invent it.

What it does not establish, and I had this wrong at first. The Greek is ἐπὶ συντελείᾳ τῶν αἰώνων — *at* or *upon* the consummation of the ages. That places Messiah's appearing **at** the culmination. It does not say that an age had already finished and lay behind the author.

So Hebrews does not, by itself, establish the stronger proposition I wanted from it: that an age can be **completely ended** while resurrection remains future. It establishes the weaker and still useful one: that consummation language and outstanding expectation can coexist.

I am recording the distance between those two, because the first is what my model needs and the second is what the text gives.

And Hebrews layers further. The same document says believers have already tasted *the powers of the age to come*

(6:5), and speaks of *the inhabited world to come* (2:5). Consummation of the ages, powers already tasted, and a world still ahead — in one book.

That is not a flat chronology. It is layered: inauguration, transition, consummation, and remaining expectation.

WHAT THAT PERMITS, AND THE CAUTION ATTACHED

The texts seem to force some distinction like this:

covenantal or historical consummation	a prior order reaches its appointed conclusion
eschatological consummation	Messiah's victory reaches its fullness, including the defeat of death

These may overlap without being the same moment.

The caution is the important half. Hebrews 9 gives me a reason to explore those categories. It does not establish that Matthew's age-consummation is the first kind. Having a valid distinction available is not the same as having shown that this particular text uses it.

MATTHEW 13 COMPLICATES IT IMMEDIATELY

At the consummation of the age, Matthew gives angels gathering, the wicked separated, fiery judgment, and the righteous shining.

That sounds considerably bigger than an administrative change.

So the distinction cuts both ways, and here is the half that cuts against me: if Matthew's age-ending event is first-century, then **the first-century event has to carry real judicial and eschatological weight.** I do not get to use the distinction to shrink AD 70 into *the Romans knocked down a building*. Matthew's own imagery would require something covenantally and judicially profound.

The distinction buys me chronological room. It does not buy me a smaller event.

A TOOL I AM INTRODUCING, AND THE BRAKE I AM ATTACHING TO IT NOW

Matthew 13:43 echoes Daniel 12:3. Which raises the possibility that Matthew is borrowing from a prophetic scene that itself compresses tribulation, deliverance, resurrection and judgment into a single visionary horizon.

The name for that is prophetic compression: a prophecy may present events separated by historical intervals together in one scene, because it is emphasizing theological relationship rather than supplying a map of intervals.

> **The brake, stated at the moment of introduction rather than later**

> Prophetic compression may not be invoked every time chronology becomes inconvenient.
>
> I am writing this down in the same paragraph that introduces the tool, because I can see exactly how useful it would be to me and that is the warning sign. A proposed separation between compressed elements requires textual, intertextual, or fulfilment-based evidence. Absent that, compression is not a hermeneutic; it is a way of not being wrong.
>
> My own hypothesis benefits from compression. That is precisely when a rule is worth having.

LUKE 4, WHERE YESHUA STOPPED PARTWAY THROUGH THE PROPHECY

The category of partial fulfilment is not something I invented for this problem. It is demonstrated, and by Yeshua.

> …to set at liberty those who are oppressed, to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor. (Luke 4:18–19)
>
> And he rolled up the scroll and gave it back to the attendant and sat down… "Today this Scripture has been fulfilled in your hearing." (Luke 4:20–21)

Now read what He was reading from:

> to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor, **and the day of vengeance of our God**; to comfort all who mourn. (Isaiah 61:2)

Both clauses sit inside what modern versification numbers as Isaiah 61:2 — one continuous prophetic unit in the scroll Yeshua was holding, which had no verse numbers in it. He

read as far as the proclamation of Yah's favour, stopped, rolled up the scroll, and declared the Scripture fulfilled.

I had understood this as *He stopped before the next passage*. A closer reading made it sharper than that. He stopped **within the same prophetic unit**, before the next coordinated clause — within what our Bibles now number as a single verse. A prophetic passage can contain multiple elements, and fulfilment of one portion can be declared without exhausting the wider prophecy; here, without exhausting even the prophetic unit he had begun.

That establishes the category. It does not establish the application to Matthew 13, and I am keeping those apart.

> **Sidebar — "one taken and one left," and what it did to a connection I wanted**
>
> I went looking at *one will be taken and one left* because it seemed likely to connect Matthew 24 with Paul's gathering. It did not go the way I expected.
>
> First, the wording. Yeshua says one is **taken** and one is **left**. He does not say one disappears.
>
> Then the analogy immediately before it: as in the days of Noah, they were unaware *until the flood came and swept them all away* — so will be the coming of the Son of Man. In that comparison, **the ones removed are the wicked generation outside the ark.**
>
> Luke sharpens it further. After the same saying, the disciples ask a question that had never registered with me: *Where, Lord?* And the answer is *Where the corpse is, there the vultures will gather.*
>
> The exact antecedent of their question is debated, but Yeshua answers with a corpse and gathering vultures, which pushes the scene toward judgment rather than making *taken* automatically mean transport to

> safety. So the popular equation — taken means gathered to Messiah — is far less automatic than I had assumed, and it may be exactly backwards.
>
> The Greek adds something I did not expect. Both verbs, παραλαμβάνεται (*paralambanetai*) and ἀφίεται (*aphietai*), are present indicative **middle or passive**. The voice is grammatically undetermined and no agent is stated.
>
> That is now the third time in this investigation that a heavily contested verse has turned out to rest on undetermined voice, alongside Romans 9:22 and Acts 13:48. In none of the three does the grammar supply the agent, which means no interpretive camp gets to claim the grammar. The recurrence is itself a finding.
>
> I went to this passage hoping for a bridge and came away with pressure on the connection I wanted. That is what the method is for.

WHERE I AM NOT ALLOWED TO GO YET

John 5 still stands where it stood last chapter: *an hour is coming, and is now here* for one thing, and *an hour is coming* for those in the tombs. Any model claiming all resurrection was completed spiritually in the first century is in serious difficulty.

So I am recording a provisional commitment rather than letting it stay vague: **my model retains bodily resurrection ahead**, unless later Scripture forces another conclusion.

Whether Matthew 24 itself contains a transition point — somewhere the text moves from first-century judgment to a later horizon — I am not deciding here. The cleanest available control is comparing Matthew 24 with Mark 13 and Luke 21,

since Luke is more explicitly tied to Jerusalem, with armies surrounding it and the city trampled. That comparison is surgical work and it is bookmarked, not done.

WHAT I AM ACTUALLY PROPOSING, AND WHAT IT IS NOT CALLED

I need to correct a label before it does damage, because the wrong one imports claims I am not making.

LABEL	WHAT IT NORMALLY MEANS
full preterism	essentially all major prophecy, including resurrection and final judgment, fulfilled in the first century
partial preterism	substantial first-century fulfilment, but the second coming, bodily resurrection, final judgment and usually the millennium remain future

My position is neither.

It is not full preterism: final judgment and other final events are emphatically retained as future. But it is not standard partial preterism either, and the reason is specific — **standard partial preterism does not place us in the little season.** It generally holds the millennium, or its consummation, to be future or present-but-unconsummated.

What I am actually working with is this: first-century fulfilment, then a first resurrection and gathering, then a thousand-year reign that actually occurred, then its end, then

Satan released, then a present little season, with final judgment still ahead.

WORKING LABEL — AND THE BURDEN THAT COMES WITH IT

Post-millennial little-season hypothesis, resting on a strong first-century fulfilment framework.

It shares partial preterism's first-century framework and adds a distinct claim: that Revelation 20's millennial reign has also already occurred, and that the present may correspond to Satan's little season. **That additional claim has to be established independently rather than smuggled in under a borrowed label.**

What the hypothesis must account for, itemized so it cannot be left vague:

1. — the timing of the first resurrection
2. — the identity of those raised
3. — what starts the thousand years
4. — what happens during the reign
5. — what marks its end

Revelation will have to supply these. If it does not, the hypothesis does not survive.

And note what the label buys, because I should be as clear about the advantage as about the burden: since the millennium sits *after* the first-century crisis, bodily resurrection could occur at the **beginning of that millennial period** rather than being equated with Jerusalem's destruction. The last chapter did not kill this hypothesis. It clarified what the hypothesis has to show.

AN OBJECTION I WAS GIVEN YEARS AGO, WHICH TURNS OUT TO BE HALF RIGHT

Someone who taught me early raised Zechariah 14 against this kind of reading, and it deserves better than the dismissal I would once have given it.

> everyone who survives of all the nations that have come against Jerusalem shall go up year after year to worship the King, the Lord of hosts, and to keep the Feast of Booths. And if any of the families of the earth do not go up… there will be no rain on them. (Zechariah 14:16–19)

Some details in the version I was given did not survive a check of the text: the festival is Sukkot, the Feast of Booths, not Passover; the frequency is year after year, not twice yearly; and Egypt is named specifically.

But the substance is real, and here is the clean formulation:

established	Zechariah anticipates a period in which surviving nations worship Yahweh, with Sukkot, Jerusalem and rain connected
not established	that this scene is identical to Revelation 20's millennium

And there is a circularity that my own method catches immediately. If someone uses Zechariah 14 to prove the millennium has not happened, they must first establish that Zechariah 14 **describes** the millennium. Otherwise the argument reduces to: this has not happened because the millenni-

um has not happened, and I know the millennium has not happened because this has not happened.

The missing step in the objection is the identification of Zechariah 14 with Revelation 20. The text is genuine. The bridge was assumed. So Zechariah 14 becomes a major control text for my hypothesis rather than a defeater of it — and if that bridge is ever supplied, it becomes a defeater.

A QUESTION INSIDE REVELATION THAT I AM NOT ANSWERING

> I saw under the altar the souls of those who had been slain… they cried out, "how long before you will judge and avenge our blood?" Then they were each given a white robe and told to rest a little longer, until the number of their fellow servants and their brothers should be complete. (Revelation 6:9–11)

Martyrs waiting, and a number still to be completed. And Revelation 20 speaks of those killed for the testimony coming to life and reigning.

Are those the same group? I cannot answer that before reading Revelation in order, and I am not going to answer it now by intuition.

ADMITTING A HISTORIAN, AND FENCING HIM

Josephus is genuinely relevant: a near-contemporary who wrote at length on the revolt and the destruction of Jerusalem. He is also not a neutral camera. He was a participant who surrendered to the Romans, received Flavian patronage, and wrote with his own political and apologetic interests. Invaluable, and interested.

He reports traditions of extraordinary portents before the catastrophe, including armies seen among the clouds. I have not checked that passage myself, so I am treating it as reported rather than verified.

> **Rule — the report is not the event**
>
> Josephus reporting armies in the clouds does not prove Matthew 24's coming on the clouds was fulfilled.
>
> A historical source can establish that a **claim, testimony or tradition existed** without establishing that the reported **event** occurred as described. Record the report first; assess the underlying event separately.
>
> And the order matters as much as the rule. Matthew, Daniel and Isaiah establish the biblical expectation first. Only then does one ask whether a contemporary historian reports phenomena that ancient observers associated with that judgment. Historical corroboration runs alongside the biblical model, never ahead of it.
>
> The same discipline applies to fixed dates. The first Council of Nicaea is conventionally AD 325, a date I am carrying rather than having verified. I am not recording that Nicaea occurred before the millennium, because that has not been established. It is a fixed historical marker whose millennial relationship is unresolved, and it goes in the historical timeline rather than the biblical argument.

A HYPOTHESIS IS NOT A REVELATION

I want to record something about how this stretch of the investigation actually felt, because leaving it out would make the record dishonest.

As the pieces began connecting, there were moments that produced an almost overwhelming sense that a hidden chronology was coming into view. Questions arrived before I had consciously gone looking for them — the martyrs awaiting their full number, the nations present during the thousand years, neighbouring clauses that appeared to separate in fulfilment. I cannot honestly deny that some of those moments felt spiritually significant to me.

But the method required a distinction precisely when the connections felt strongest. An impression can tell me what question to investigate. It cannot tell me what conclusion I am entitled to reach. If I believe the Ruach guides into truth, the same Scriptures tell me to test everything — so the stronger the intuition, the more carefully the claim needs testing, not less.

That protects both sides. I do not have to dismiss every unexpected connection as coincidence, and I do not have to baptize every intuition as revelation. An impression becomes a research question. Scripture, evidence, correction and time decide what survives.

So from here on, where an impression drove an inquiry, I will say so plainly — and then it gets tested exactly like everything else.

THE PROVISIONAL ANSWER, WHICH IS NARROWER THAN THE QUESTION

I asked whether an age can end while resurrection remains ahead. I wanted a yes. What the texts actually give me is this:

Scripture permits the distinction my hypothesis needs. It has not established its application to Matthew's age.

That is the honest form of the result. Hebrews shows that consummation language can coexist with eschatological realities still outstanding — so the category exists, and a first-century consummation of *an* age does not by itself require final bodily resurrection at the same moment. What Hebrews does not show is that the age in question had already completely ended, and Matthew's age is not the age Hebrews is talking about anyway.

So I have a permission and not a demonstration. The question in this chapter's title does not get a yes; it gets *not ruled out, and not yet earned.*

I would rather record that than round it up. Rounding it up is how a model stops being tested.

Two constraints travel with even that narrower answer, and neither is optional. Matthew 13's harvest and its Danielic imagery forbid reducing that consummation to administrative change; if the first century is the right horizon, the event must still account for genuine divine judgment. And bodily resurrection remains strongly future relative to several apostolic texts, unless Revelation later supplies a demonstrable staged chronology.

WHERE THIS LEAVES US. The distinction the model needed exists in Scripture rather than only in my convenience: Hebrews places Messiah's appearing *at* the consummation of the ages while still awaiting a second appearing, and Yeshua declared Isaiah 61 fulfilled while stopping partway through what our Bibles number as verse 2. So consummation language can coexist with eschatological realities still outstanding. What that does **not** establish is that the age in view had already completely ended — Hebrews places the appearing at the culmination, not after it — nor that Matthew's age is the age being consummated. The chapter therefore ends with a permission rather than a demonstration. What it also does not license is a shrunken first-century event, a compression invoked whenever chronology is inconvenient, or any claim that bodily resurrection is behind us. The position now has a correct name and an itemized burden, and Zechariah 14 stands as a control text whose bridge to Revelation 20 nobody has yet built.

THE QUESTION THIS LEAVES. A permission, not a verdict. The hypothesis survived the hardest pressure so far and came out smaller, better labelled, and carrying five specific burdens — and carrying one more piece of honesty than it had at the start of the chapter, since the answer I wanted was a yes and the answer I am entitled to is narrower than that. What remains is the last great Tanakh text standing between me and Revelation — the one that has been waiting since Matthew's harvest first echoed it.

Chapter 29: Daniel 12, and the door into Revelation

I have been putting this chapter off since Matthew's harvest first echoed it, and the delay was deliberate. I wanted to reach Daniel 12 at a point where I could not use it as ammunition — where the controls were already built, so the chapter could do whatever it was going to do to me.

One rule before entering. Daniel 12 does not detach from Daniel 11 merely because it contains the famous resurrection language. Its opening *at that time* takes its referent from the conflict just described. Daniel 11 will eventually need its own work; the internal structure of Daniel 12 can still be mapped now.

MICHAEL, AND WHOSE PEOPLE THIS IS ABOUT

> At that time shall arise Michael, the great prince who has charge of your people. And there shall be a time of trouble, such as never has been since there was a nation till that time. But at that time your people shall be delivered, everyone whose name shall be found written in the book.
> (Daniel 12:1)

Michael is tied to **Daniel's people**. Israel's covenantal crisis is in the foreground from the first clause, not somewhere in the background.

And Matthew is clearly reaching for this:

> For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been from the beginning of the world until now, no, and never will be. (Matthew 24:21)

Whatever Daniel's distress is, Matthew expects his reader to remember it.

Note also the pairing inside that one verse: distress **and** the deliverance of those written in the book. That is the remnant pattern this investigation has met repeatedly — never the whole nation, never nobody.

THE RESURRECTION TEXT, AND THE DATUM I HAVE BEEN CARRYING

> And many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt. (Daniel 12:2)

The Hebrew is יְשֵׁנֵי אַדְמַת־עָפָר (*yeshenê admat-ʿafar*) — roughly *sleepers of the dust-ground*. That is not naturally read as spiritually drowsy living Israelites. Symbolic dimensions may exist. Bodily resurrection carries substantial prima facie weight.

And now I have to deal with the word I set down four chapters ago and promised not to use.

> **FINDING — AND IT GOES AGAINST ME**
>
> Daniel says רַבִּים (*rabbim*) — *many*, not *all*. I recorded it twice and refused to build on it, because it was obviously going to be useful later.
>
> Here is why that restraint was correct, and why the datum can never be more than a datum:
>
> **Biblical *many* can function as a broad collective rather than meaning, mathematically, *some but definitely not all*.**
>
> So the inference I could feel forming — *Daniel says many, therefore perhaps only a limited group rises, therefore Revelation's first-resurrection martyrs might fit* — is too quick. It is possible. It is **not established by the word *rabbim***.
>
> That is exactly the lexical overreach this method exists to prevent, and this time it would have been an overreach in my own favour. Formally blocked.
>
> Daniel 12:2 leaves the scope question more open than an English arithmetic reading suggests, and more open than I wanted it.

THE SHINING, AND WHAT IT DOES TO MATTHEW 13

> And those who are wise shall shine like the brightness of the sky above; and those who turn many to righteousness, like the stars forever and ever. (Daniel 12:3)

Against Matthew's *then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father*.

So Matthew's harvest language is not generic judgment imagery. It taps Daniel's specific sequence: distress, deliverance, resurrection, the righteous shining.

Which makes Daniel 12 one of the strongest pressure texts against any reading of Matthew 13 that reduces the harvest to the destruction of Jerusalem as an administrative event. Something more eschatological is in play, and I have now been told this by three chapters in a row.

THE SEALING, STATED TWICE

> But you, Daniel, shut up the words and seal the book, until the time of the end. (Daniel 12:4)
>
> Go your way, Daniel, for the words are shut up and sealed until the time of the end. (Daniel 12:9)

Twice, bracketing the closing section. Daniel receives a prophecy whose fulfilment is far enough from him that sealing is commanded.

Hold that. It becomes the door at the end of this chapter.

A MODERNIZATION I AM REFUSING

> Many shall run to and fro, and knowledge shall increase. (Daniel 12:4)

This verse gets turned into airplanes, cars and the internet with remarkable regularity.

> **WORD STUDY — יְשֹׁטְטוּ (*YESHOTEṬU*) AND הַדָּעַת (*HA-DAʿAT*)**
>
> יְשֹׁטְטוּ (*yeshoteṭu*) — rendered by the Revised JPS as **range far and wide**.
>
> הַדָּעַת (*ha-daʿat*) — **the** knowledge. Definite article.
>
> Two contextual facts decide how much weight the modern reading can carry. This clause sits **immediately after the sealing command**, and **immediately before Daniel says he does not understand**.
>
> In that setting, the ranging may well be ranging *through the book*, and *the knowledge* may concern understanding *the prophecy* rather than technological knowledge in general.
>
> I am not asserting that reading either. I am saying the technological one has not been earned, and a reading that requires the nineteenth century to make sense of a sixth-century-BC text should have to earn it.

"HOW LONG?" — AND AN ANSWER THAT IS NOT A DATE

> How long shall it be till the end of these wonders? (Daniel 12:6)

> ...it would be for a time, times, and half a time, and that when the shattering of the power of the holy people comes to an end all these things would be finished. (Daniel 12:7)

The completion marker is not a calendar date. It is **an event**: the shattering of the power of the holy people. And *the holy people* in Daniel's own context is Daniel's people, which places the whole prophecy inside Israel's covenantal story rather than floating free of it.

That is potentially very relevant to first-century Jerusalem. It is also exactly where precision is required before anyone identifies it with AD 70, and I am not making that identification here.

As for *a time, times, and half a time* — it appears again at Daniel 7:25, and it is associated in later apocalyptic interpretation with forty-two months and 1,260 days. Those will matter enormously at Revelation. And the brake that killed my trumpet bridge applies unchanged: a shared apocalyptic number raises an intertextual question. It does not establish that every such period is the same historical interval.

THE VERSE I DID NOT EXPECT TO BE THE MOST IMPORTANT ONE

> I heard, but I did not understand. Then I said, "O my lord, what shall be the outcome of these things?" (Daniel 12:8)

And the answer he receives is not an explanation. It is verse 9 restating that the words are sealed until the time of the end.

> **The prophet received the vision and still did not understand the chronology**
>
> I am deep into building a chronology. The man who was given this vision says plainly that he heard and did not understand, asks for the outcome, and is told the words are sealed.
>
> That is a control on me, not a devotional aside. Some realities become intelligible only in their appointed time, and the person closest to the revelation was not exempt.
>
> It is the same shape this investigation has kept running into: humility that arrives **after** the reasoning rather than instead of it. Daniel asked. He was not rebuked for asking. He also did not get the answer.

There is a second epistemological datum in the next verse, and it needs a guard attached in the same breath.

> Many shall purify themselves and make themselves white and be refined, but the wicked shall act wickedly. And none of the wicked shall understand, but those who are wise shall understand. (Daniel 12:10)

Daniel ties discernment to covenantal faithfulness rather than to intellectual capacity alone. That is genuinely in the text.

And it must never become a device for dismissing disagreement as wickedness. It does not mean only morally impressive people understand prophecy, and anyone who uses it that way — including me, about people who reject what this book

concludes — has turned a biblical datum into a rhetorical weapon.

THE TEMPLE MARKER, WHICH ANCHORS THE WHOLE THING

> And from the time that the regular burnt offering is taken away and the abomination that makes desolate is set up, there shall be 1,290 days. (Daniel 12:11)

This is an explicitly sacrificial and Temple-anchored chronological marker. The regular offering removed; the abomination set up.

That reconnects Daniel 12 to Daniel 9, to Daniel 11, to Matthew 24, and to Jerusalem's actual history. It makes a first-century horizon more plausible than a reading detached from Jerusalem altogether. Not proven — but the textual architecture demands that Temple history be investigated rather than waved at.

AND THE NUMBERS, WHICH I AM NOT GOING TO PLAY WITH

> Blessed is he who waits and arrives at the 1,335 days. (Daniel 12:12)

1,290 days. 1,335 days. A difference of forty-five.

I do not know what the forty-five days represent, and I am not going to invent a meaning for them. This is precisely the kind of text where interpreters start matching intervals against history until something lines up, and calling the result a discovery.

> **The required order, fixed before any historical candidate is consulted**
>
> 1. Identify the starting marker.
> 2. Establish the calendar assumptions.
> 3. Determine whether the days are literal or symbolic.
> 4. **Only then** compare historical candidates.
>
> No numerology fishing. The rule is the same one that will govern the millennium: freeze the prediction first, then inspect the data. Reversing those two steps is how anyone can prove anything.

DANIEL RESTS, AND THEN STANDS

> But go your way till the end. And you shall rest and shall stand in your allotted place at the end of the days. (Daniel 12:13)

Daniel rests, and later stands. That reads very naturally as death followed by resurrection and vindication.

And notice what that does to the chapter as a whole. It **opens** with sleepers awakening from the dust and **closes** with Daniel himself promised that after resting he will stand. The bookending strengthens the bodily reading rather than

weakening it, and it does so at both ends of the passage I would most like to soften.

YESHUA PUTS DANIEL IN THE FIRST CENTURY, AND LUKE SAYS HOW

> So when you see the abomination of desolation spoken of by the prophet Daniel, standing in the holy place (let the reader understand)… (Matthew 24:15)

He is not quoting Daniel ornamentally. He reactivates Daniel's time-of-the-end imagery in relation to His own audience's crisis and tells them to **recognize** it.

And then Luke, describing the same discourse, translates the imagery into something a person could see coming down a road:

> But when you see Jerusalem surrounded by armies, then know that its desolation has come near… for these are days of vengeance, to fulfill all that is written. (Luke 21:20–22)

That is an enormous synoptic control. Matthew gives *the abomination of desolation*; Luke gives *Jerusalem surrounded by armies*. It strongly supports a historical siege referent for at least part of the Daniel and Matthew desolation language.

One restraint on Luke's phrase, because I can feel it being over-read: *to fulfill all that is written* in context is not *all prophecy everywhere*. Luke is interpreting Jerusalem's crisis

in scriptural-fulfilment terms, which is significant enough without inflating it.

And Luke has an *until* that I am not allowed to over-read either:

> Jerusalem will be trampled underfoot by the Gentiles, until the times of the Gentiles are fulfilled. (Luke 21:24)

One caution applies here, and it will apply to every *until* in this book; call it the until-reversal caution. *Until* guarantees the state **through** that point and does not by itself establish what follows. It may also be evidence of staging inside Luke 21 itself, which bears directly on whether Matthew 24 contains a transition marker. Recorded, not resolved.

WHERE THIS LEAVES ME

The chain is strong: Daniel, Temple and desolation, Yeshua applying Daniel to the Jerusalem crisis, Luke identifying armies around the city, and *this generation*. That is very strong evidence for substantial first-century fulfilment.

The unresolved core is equally clear: **how much of Daniel 12's resurrection horizon belongs to that same fulfilment?**

A first-century reading of Daniel 12 must do one of three things. Demonstrate staged fulfilment. Demonstrate prophetic compression, with the brake attached — evidence, not

convenience. Or explain the resurrection language in some other textually defensible way.

What it may not do is declare the whole chapter fulfilled in AD 70 without addressing resurrection at all.

And this sharpens the label question from the last chapter. A standard partial-preterist reading can say the Jerusalem-judgment elements were fulfilled while bodily resurrection remains future, and that is **textually easier** than what I am proposing. My hypothesis goes further and therefore has more to prove.

OPEN QUESTION — AND IT IS THE ONE PART VI EXISTS TO ANSWER

If Revelation's first resurrection is bodily resurrection of martyrs and the millennium is already past, then a historical first resurrection must have occurred at or before the start of that period — and it has to be reconcilable with Daniel 12, John 5, Luke 20, 1 Corinthians 15 and 1 Thessalonians 4.

If Revelation instead defines the first resurrection differently, **that definition has to come from Revelation.**

Either way, Revelation has to do the work. I may not predefine *first resurrection* in order to save the hypothesis, and if I catch myself doing it, that is the falsification condition arriving rather than an objection to be answered.

THE DOOR

Here is the contrast that ends this Part, and it is the reason the next one exists.

TEXT	COMMAND	WHAT THE TEXT ATTACHES TO IT
Daniel 12:4	**seal** the book	a terminus — *until the time of the end*
Daniel 12:9	the words are **sealed**	a terminus — *until the time of the end*
Revelation 22:10	**do not seal**	a reason — *for the time is near*

And Revelation opens the same way it closes:

> The revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show to his servants the things that must soon take place. (Revelation 1:1)
>
> Blessed is the one who reads aloud the words of this prophecy… for the time is near. (Revelation 1:3)

FINDING — THIS IS VERBAL OPPOSITION, NOT THEMATIC RESEMBLANCE

Daniel is told to seal the words **until the time of the end**. John is told not to seal **because the time is near**. The commands move in opposite directions, and the temporal expressions attached to them create a deliberate contrast.

I want to keep the asymmetry visible rather than tidy it into a matching pair, because the two texts are not doing the same grammatical thing. Daniel is given a **terminus**: seal, and the sealing runs until a point named as the time of the end. Revelation is given a **reason**: do not seal, *for* the time is near. That Daniel's sealing implies the end was not yet upon him is a fair inference from the terminus — but it is an inference, and Revelation's *for* is explicit wording. I am not going to write the inference as though it were the quotation.

After all these chapters of refusing to build on resemblance, it is worth saying what makes this different anyway. I am not noticing that two passages feel similar. I am reading one book instructed to seal until a horizon, and another book instructed not to seal because that horizon is close.

At minimum: Revelation presents itself as standing much closer to its fulfilment horizon than Daniel did.

What this does not establish: that every event in Revelation occurred immediately, or what the scope of *near* is, or what *soon* refers to. The nearness claim is Revelation's own, and the right response is to read Revelation before imposing an outside chronology on it.

That is where I stop building controls. I have enough. What I do not have is Revelation, and I am not permitted to arrive there at chapter twenty.

THE GROWING CHAIN — CHECKPOINT 3

A first-century horizon is real. What it reaches is not yet settled.

WHERE THIS LEAVES US. Daniel 12 anchors its prophecy to Israel, the Temple, the removal of the regular offering and an event-marker rather than a date, and Yeshua reactivates that language for his own generation while Luke translates it into armies around Jerusalem. The first-century horizon is genuine. But the same chapter opens with sleepers awakening from dust and closes with Daniel promised that he will rest and stand, and *rabbim* has now been adjudicated in a way that removes rather than supplies a convenient reading. So resurrection cannot be deleted from the horizon to preserve the judgment. And Daniel is told to seal until the time of the end, while Revelation is told not to seal because the time is near — opposite commands with contrasting temporal expressions, and the first piece of temporal evidence that has come from the books' own instructions about themselves.

THE QUESTION THIS LEAVES. A door, and the right to walk through it. Every control this investigation has built now travels with me: the resurrection taxonomy, classification before harmonizing, metaphorical against bodily, inauguration against consummation, consummation against exhaustion, the compression brake, the until-reversal caution, report against event, and the seal-nearness contrast that just opened.

What it did not earn is a conclusion. I am entering Revelation at chapter one, with a hypothesis that carries five specific burdens and a falsification condition I still have to write down before a single vision is interpreted. If the book does not supply what the hypothesis needs, the hypothesis is what gives way.